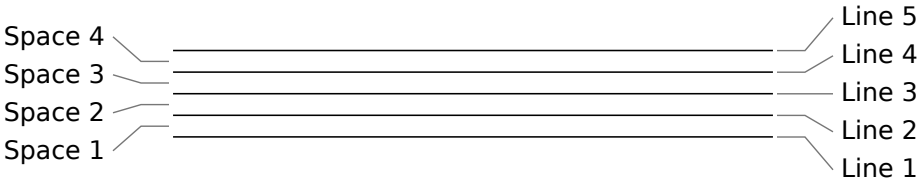
What Written Music Shows

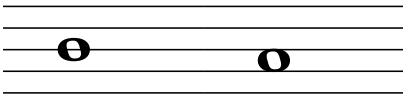
Written music records two things about every sound: how high or low it is, and how long it lasts. **Pitch** is the highness or lowness of a sound. **Duration** is the length of time a sound lasts. Pitch is shown by where a note sits on the page. Duration is shown by the shape of the note.

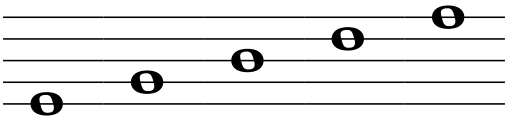
The staff

A **staff** is a set of five horizontal lines and the four spaces between them. Notes are written on the staff. Lines and spaces are numbered from the bottom up: the lowest line is line 1 and the top line is line 5; the lowest space is space 1 and the top space is space 4.



A **note** is a symbol for a single sound. A note sits either on a line, with the line passing through its middle, or in a space, filling the space between two lines. The higher a note sits on the staff, the higher its pitch.





The musical alphabet

The **musical alphabet** uses seven letters: A B C D E F G. After G, the letters start again at A. Moving up in pitch, the letters go forward. Moving down, they go backward.

Going up →	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	A	B	C
Going down →	G	F	E	D	C	B	A	G	F	E

On the staff, each move from a line to the next space, or from a space to the next line, is one letter of the musical alphabet. A move from one line to the next line skips one letter.

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Name _____ Date _____

The Staff and the Alphabet

A. Lines and spaces Write the number that answers each item.

EXAMPLE Lines on a staff: 5

1. Spaces on a staff: _____
2. Number of the bottom line: _____
3. Number of the top line: _____
4. Number of the top space: _____
5. Space between lines 2 and 3: _____
6. Space between lines 4 and 5: _____
7. Line directly above space 3: _____
8. Line directly above space 1: _____
9. Letters in the musical alphabet: _____

B. The musical alphabet Fill in the missing letters.

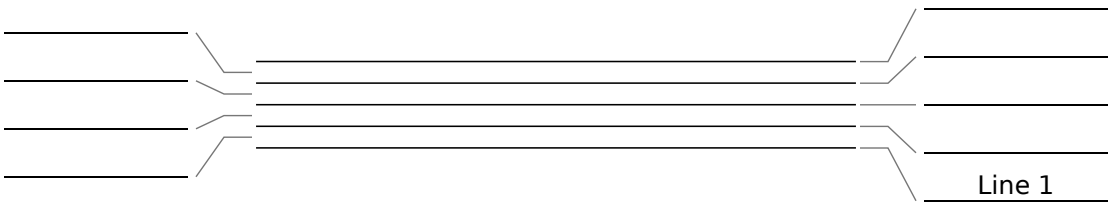
EXAMPLE	Going up	C	D	E	F	G	A	B	C
1.	Going up	E	F		A		C	D	
2.	Going up	A		C		E	F		A
3.	Going down	G	F		D	C		A	
4.	Going down	C		A	G		E		C

C. Before and after Write the letter that comes before or after the given letter.

EXAMPLE After C: D

1. After G: _____
2. Before A: _____
3. After E: _____
4. Before C: _____
5. After B: _____
6. Before F: _____
7. After D: _____
8. Before D: _____
9. Before G: _____
10. After F: _____
11. Before B: _____

D. Label the staff Write the name of each line (Line 1 to Line 5) and each space (Space 1 to Space 4).



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